

OUR VISION FOR 2037

Format 1 · Vision-led

By 2037, the Coldwater Basin is a landscape defined by resilience and reciprocity. Clean, reliable water flows from healthy headwaters to the valley's communities. Forests and rangelands carry fire and drought without breaking. Working lands and wildlife share a productive future. And every resident can find connection and belonging in the places we steward together.

The vision is a destination, not a schedule. Six enduring pillars carry us there. For each, we describe the future we want, the strategies we will pursue over five years, and the signs that tell us we are on course.

PILLAR 1 OF 6

1 Water & Watershed Health

We see a basin where water is treated as a shared inheritance rather than a contested resource: streams that run cool and connected, headwaters that hold snow longer, and neighbors, tribes, and producers who make decisions about water in the same room, with the same information.

FIVE-YEAR STRATEGIES

- Restore priority riparian corridors so the basin's most degraded reaches begin to heal and reconnect.
- Convene water users, tribal partners, and municipalities around durable, voluntary water-sharing arrangements.
- Grow a basin-wide monitoring and community-science network so everyone shares a common picture of conditions.
- Partner with producers to modernize irrigation and keep more water in-stream during the driest months.

Signs of progress. Healthier, more connected stream reaches. Water-sharing conversations that start earlier and stay civil. Residents and producers who describe the river as “ours” rather than “theirs.”